SHAKTI HACKATHON 2026 · ROUND 1 IDEA SUBMISSION

Saakshi

साक्षी · साक्ष्मी · *the witness*



An SOS gets help to her. Saakshi gets justice to her.

Saakshi silently records harassment, seals the evidence so no one can claim it was edited, and explains her rights in her own language.

TRACK
Women Safety / Blockchain

TEAM
Appvengers

BUILT WITH
AI agents · Polygon · PWA

Ashtami night, North Kolkata

Ria is 20. She has waited all year for this night.

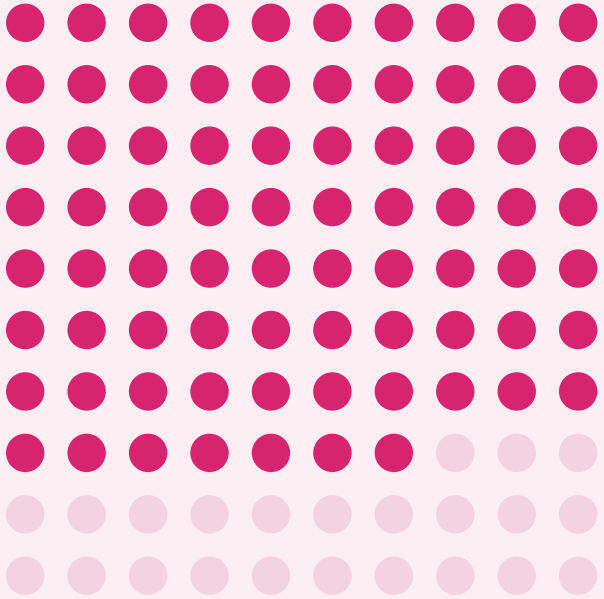
10:40 pm	The pandal queue is packed. The dhak drowns out her friend Payel.
10:41 pm	A hand grabs her from behind. Nobody saw, or everyone looked away.
10:55 pm	He follows her to the metro. All she has is a shaky 9-second video.
Next day	At the station: “Are you sure it was him? Your video shows nothing.”

“Where is your proof?”

Ria goes home. She never files the complaint. Like three in four women who face violence, she tells no one.

RIA IS A COMPOSITE. HER NIGHT IS NOT.

Ria is far from alone



77

of every 100 women who face violence never tell anyone or seek help.

NFHS-5 (2019–21), as reported

4,48,211

crimes against women registered in 2023, over 1,200 a day.

1 in 5

cases of crime against women ended in a conviction, 2017–2023.

3.7%

conviction rate for crimes against women in West Bengal, 2023.

Ask any woman you know. She has a story she never reported.

Sources: NCRB, Crime in India 2023 (via PTI, Sep 2025). NFHS-5 help-seeking data as reported. The Wire analysis of NCRB data, 2017–2023.

Help arrives. Belief doesn't

01

THE MOMENT

SOS apps alert her family and the police. That part works.

02

THE EVIDENCE

Phone snatched, files lost, and the video dismissed as edited.

03

THE REPORT

Which law applies? Which office? What if he finds the app?

04

THE COURT

Courts need a certificate with the file's hash. Few have it.

WHERE TODAY'S APPS STOP

WHERE RIA WAS LEFT ALONE, AND WHERE SAAKSHI BEGINS

SUPREME COURT · 2026

Electronic evidence must be certified with its hash value.

Section 63(4), Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, upheld in Pune Bar Association v. Union of India. Saakshi records that hash the second evidence is captured.

Three women, three kinds of harm

Ria, 20

STUDENT · NORTH KOLKATA

Groped in an Ashtami crowd, then followed to the metro. Her only proof is a shaky 9-second video.

"No one will believe me."

SAAKSHI GIVES HER

Silent capture, sealed evidence and a ready Zero FIR.

Mitali, 34

HOMEMAKER · HOWRAH

Her husband checks her phone every night. Cruelty at home is India's most-reported crime against women.

"If he finds out, it gets worse."

SAAKSHI GIVES HER

A journal hidden inside a calculator, and a duress PIN.

Ananya, 19

FIRST-YEAR STUDENT · DURGAPUR

Morphed photos of her are spreading on Instagram. Her college group chat has already seen them.

"By morning, everyone will have seen it."

SAAKSHI GIVES HER

A sealed screenshot vault and a takedown request the same night.

Composite characters. Cruelty by husband or relatives: 1,33,676 cases in 2023 (NCRB, Crime in India 2023).

At dawn on Mahalaya, Kumartuli's artisans paint the goddess's eyes. They call it chokkhu daan (চক্ষুদান), the gift of sight.

Saakshi gives every woman a witness that never looks away.

01

Capture.

Three taps start a silent SOS. Audio, video and location stream out, encrypted.

02

Prove.

Fingerprinted on her phone, sealed on Polygon. No one can claim it was edited.

03

Act.

An AI agent explains which laws apply and drafts the complaint, in Bengali, Hindi or English.

Invisible until she needs it



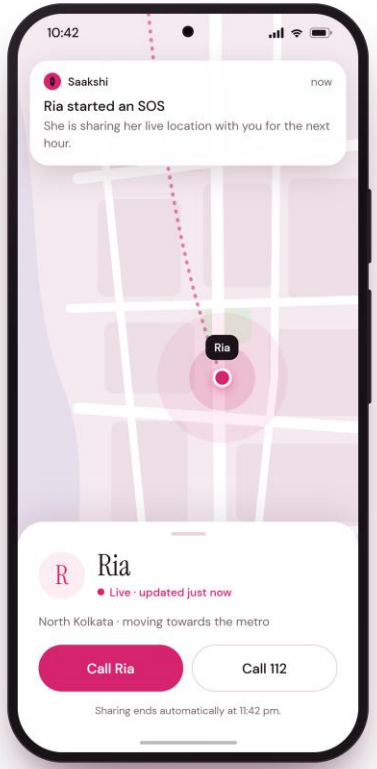
01 · DISGUISE

A working calculator. Her PIN and = opens Saakshi.



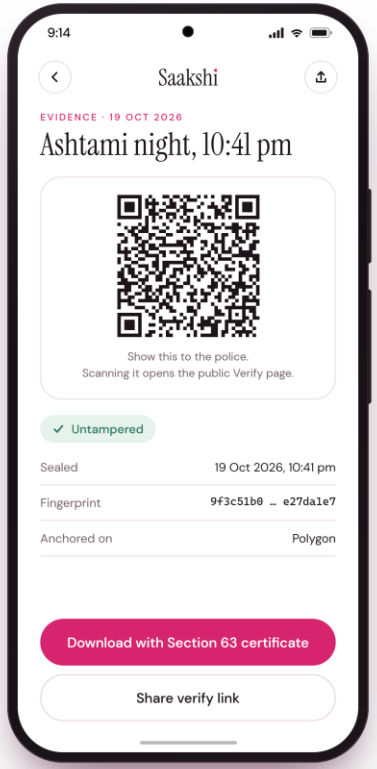
02 · SILENT SOS

Three taps. The screen goes dark.



03 · NOT ALONE

Payel gets an alert and Ria's live location for an hour.



04 · PROOF

One QR code any officer can scan to verify it.

Ashtami night, again

10:41 pm

TRIGGER

Three taps on her calculator. The screen goes dark.

10:41 pm

CAPTURE AND SEAL

Recording starts. The first piece is sealed on Polygon.

10:42 pm

NOT ALONE

Payel sees Ria's live location. They find each other.

11:30 pm

UNDERSTAND

Saakshi explains her rights in Bengali and drafts a Zero FIR.

Next day

BELIEVED

The officer scans her QR code. Untampered, sealed at 10:41 pm.

তুমি একা নও

You are not alone. The first thing her screen says.

"Where is your proof?"

"Here it is."

The ten arms of Saakshi

As the SHAKTI brief puts it: "Devi Durga wields ten arms, each channelling a Shakti."

01 **Duress PIN**
Looks like cancel, silently escalates

02 **Disguise mode**
Hides behind a working calculator

03 **Chunked streaming**
Evidence leaves her phone every five seconds

04 **Tamper-proof seal**
SHA-256 fingerprint, timestamped on Polygon

05 **Gasless by design**
No wallet, no crypto, no fees for her

06 **Public Verify page**
Anyone can check a file in one click

07 **AI legal agent**
Explains the law kindly, and cites it

08 **Her language**
Speak or type in Bengali, Hindi or English

09 **Consent first**
Location sharing is time-limited and visible

10 **Works offline**
Queues evidence and syncs when back online

How a recording becomes proof

CIPHERTEXT ONLY

ON HER PHONE

Fingerprinted first

In 5-second pieces

SHA-256, then AES-GCM

Queued when offline

FINGERPRINTS ONLY

SAAKSHI CLOUD

Stored, encrypted

Row-level security

Ciphertext only

Fingerprints batched

PUBLIC PROOF

POLYGON

Sealed in public

EvidenceAnchor contract

One root, many files

No personal data, ever

ANYONE, ANYWHERE

Verified by anyone

Verify page and QR code

Section 63 certificate

File never uploaded

ALONGSIDE: THE AI AGENT

Claude API with tool-calling, answering only from a curated corpus of Indian law, always with citations. Bengali and Hindi voice through the Web Speech API. It drafts the complaint and the Section 63 certificate for her to review.

NEXT.JS · TYPESCRIPT · TAILWIND · SUPABASE · SOLIDITY · HARDHAT · ETHERS.JS · POLYGON AMOY · CLAUDE API · WEB PUSH · VERCEL

Only a fingerprint goes on-chain

ON-CHAIN

One salted fingerprint per batch, and the moment it was sealed.

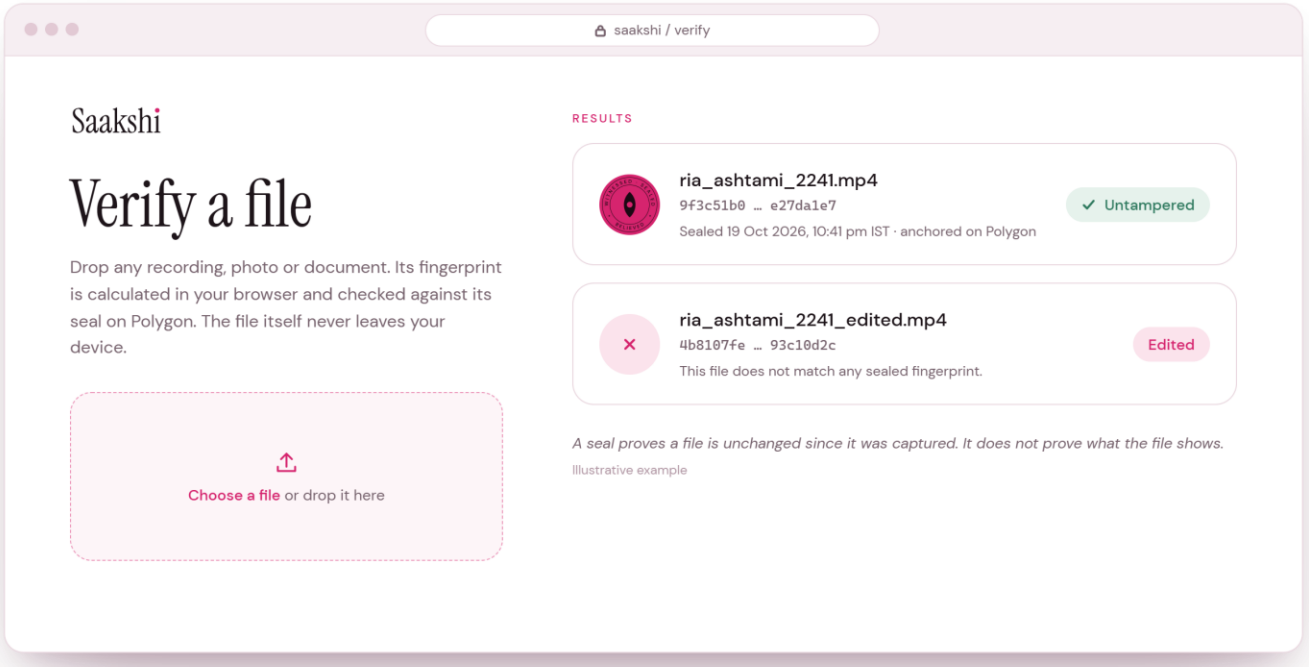
NEVER ON-CHAIN

Her video, voice, location and name.

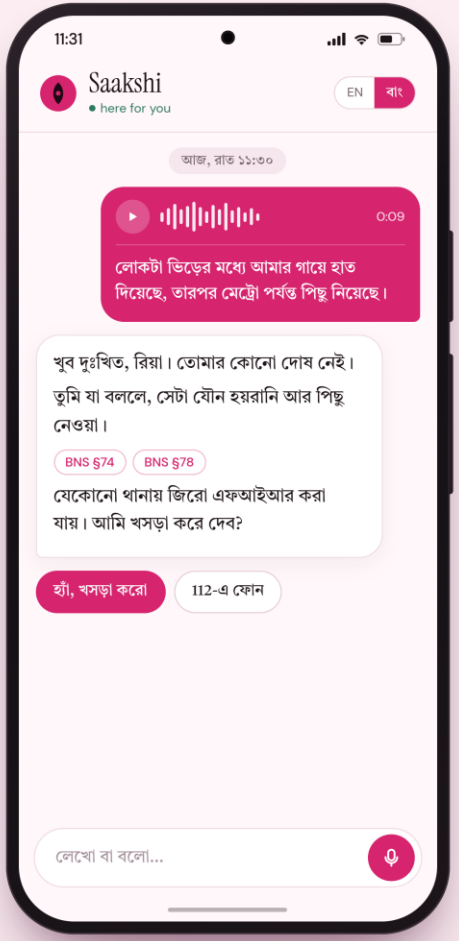
Merkle batching. Thousands of files per transaction, a fraction of a rupee each.

Gasless. Saakshi pays the network fee. She never needs a wallet.

Erasure built in. Delete the encrypted file and its key, and nothing personal remains.



It answers like an elder sister would



WHAT SHE HEARS, IN ENGLISH

"I'm so sorry, Ria. It's not your fault. What you describe is sexual harassment and stalking (BNS §74, §78). A Zero FIR can be filed at any police station. Shall I draft it?"

01 **Triage**
Hears her voice or text in Bengali, Hindi or English.

02 **Legal**
Answers only from curated Indian law, always cited.

03 **Drafting**
Writes the complaint, Zero FIR request and certificate.

04 **Routing**
Points her to 112, 181, the NCW or free legal aid.

NEVER FILES WITHOUT CONSENT · EVERY CLAIM CITED · LEGAL AID: NALSA 15100

The questions she would ask

"What if he snatches my phone?"

The evidence has already left it, five seconds at a time.

"What if he goes through my phone?"

He sees a calculator. No notifications, instant quick-exit.

"What if I press it by mistake?"

Ten seconds to undo. Calling 112 is always her choice.

"What if the app gets the law wrong?"

It answers only from cited legal text, and she reviews first.

"What if Saakshi itself is hacked?"

Files are encrypted on her phone before they leave it.

"What if he forces me to cancel?"

The duress PIN looks like a cancel and silently escalates.

"What if they say my video is edited?"

The blockchain seal from capture time proves it isn't.

"What if I don't want the police?"

Evidence stays sealed for later. NGOs and counsellors too.

"What if someone uses this to track me?"

Sharing is consent-based, time-limited and always visible.

"What if I'm under 18?"

Routes to POCSO-specific help and Childline 1098.

A working product in four days

21

OCTOBER

Calculator disguise, duress PIN, encrypted 5-second capture, live on Vercel

22

OCTOBER

Polygon Amoy contract, Merkle batching, Verify page, QR, guardian alerts

23

OCTOBER

AI agent with a cited legal corpus, complaint and Section 63 PDF, journal, vault

24

OCTOBER

Offline queue, tests on real Android phones, demo video recorded

PROJECT OWNERSHIP

Written from scratch during SHAKTI. The public GitHub history shows every step.

AFTER THE HACKATHON

1. Co-design with women students and a Kolkata NGO
2. Native Android: power-button trigger, SMS fallback
3. Integration with ERSS 112 and e-FIR portals

From “Where is your proof?” to “Here it is”

For Ria

Walks into any police station with sealed evidence and a ready Zero FIR, and is taken seriously.

For Mitali

Builds a dated record of abuse he can’t find or erase: the pattern protection-order cases rest on.

For Ananya

Sends her takedown request the same night, with proof of exactly when she acted.

WHAT A PILOT WILL MEASURE

- Incidents with sealed, verifiable evidence
- Time from incident to a filed complaint
- Integrity checks passed at verification
- Women who felt able to act (follow-up survey)

SUSTAINABLE BY DESIGN

- Free forever for every woman who needs it
- Paid POSH dashboards for colleges and companies
- Integrations for state police and NGOs

UN SDG 5 · GENDER EQUALITY

UN SDG 16 · PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

For five days, we worship Shakti in every pandal.

Saakshi is for the other 360.

Every woman deserves a witness.

ধন্যবাদ Thank you



PROJECT
Saakshi

TEAM
Appvengers

TRACK
02 · Dharma & Trust